

Module 8

Continual improvement

Syllabus

4.6 The ITIL Continual Improvement Model

4.6.1 List the steps of the ITIL Continual Improvement Model (5.6.1)

4.6.2 Understand the steps of the ITIL Continual Improvement Model (5.6.1.1-5.6.1.7)

4.6.3 Describe continual improvement within the ITIL Value System and its role in the organization (5.7)



What you will learn

By the end of this module, you will be able to:

- describe continual improvement within the ITIL Value System and its role in organizations
- understand the steps of the ITIL Continual Improvement Model.



What is continual improvement?



Continual improvement

A recurring organizational activity performed at all levels of an organization to ensure that the organization continually meets stakeholders' expectations.



Need for continual improvement

Continual improvement takes place **at all levels of the organization**. It applies to the entire ITIL Value System, including products, services, practices, and relationships.



Continual improvement

The **ITIL Continual Improvement Model** guides organizations in structured, iterative improvements.

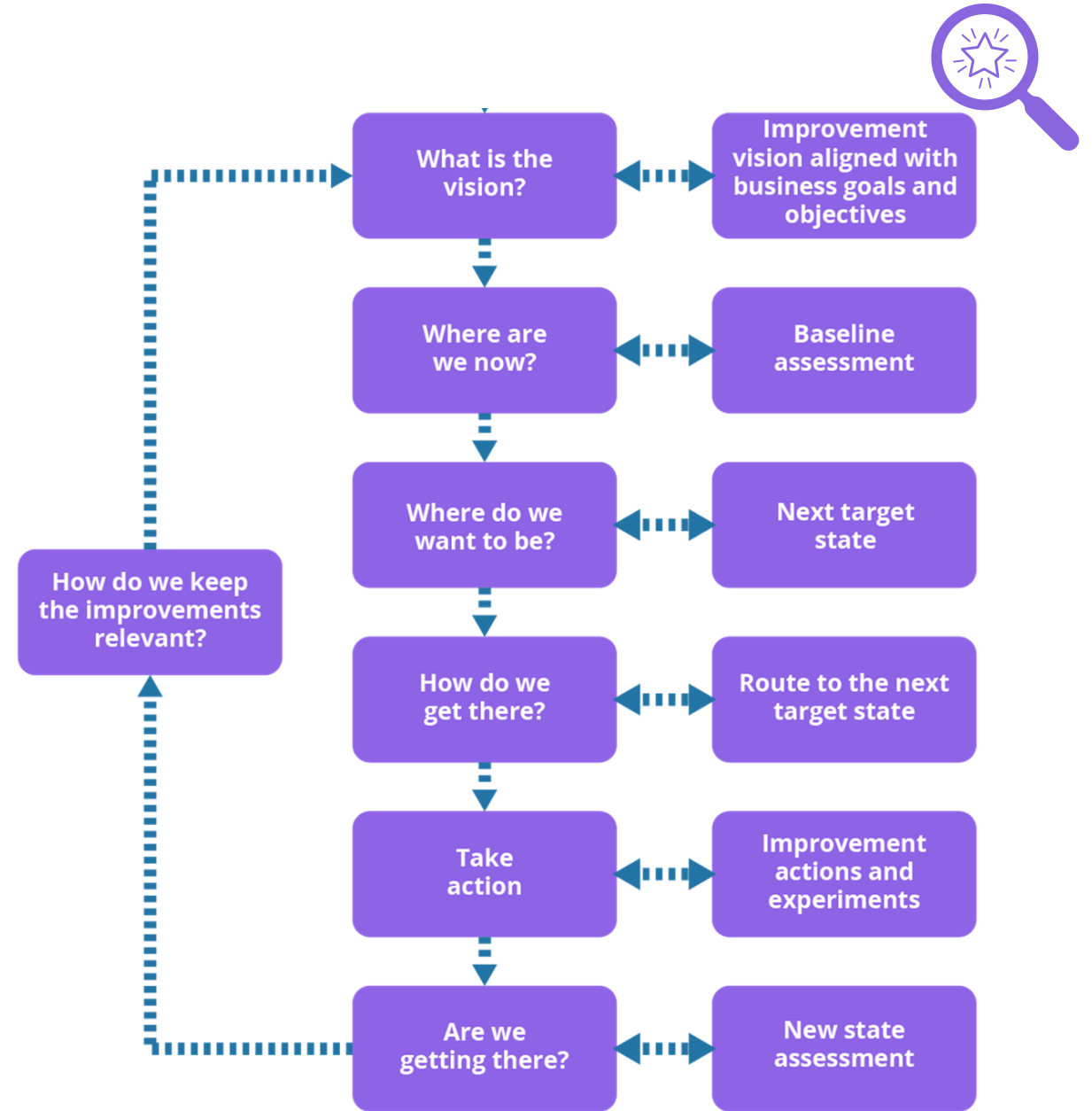
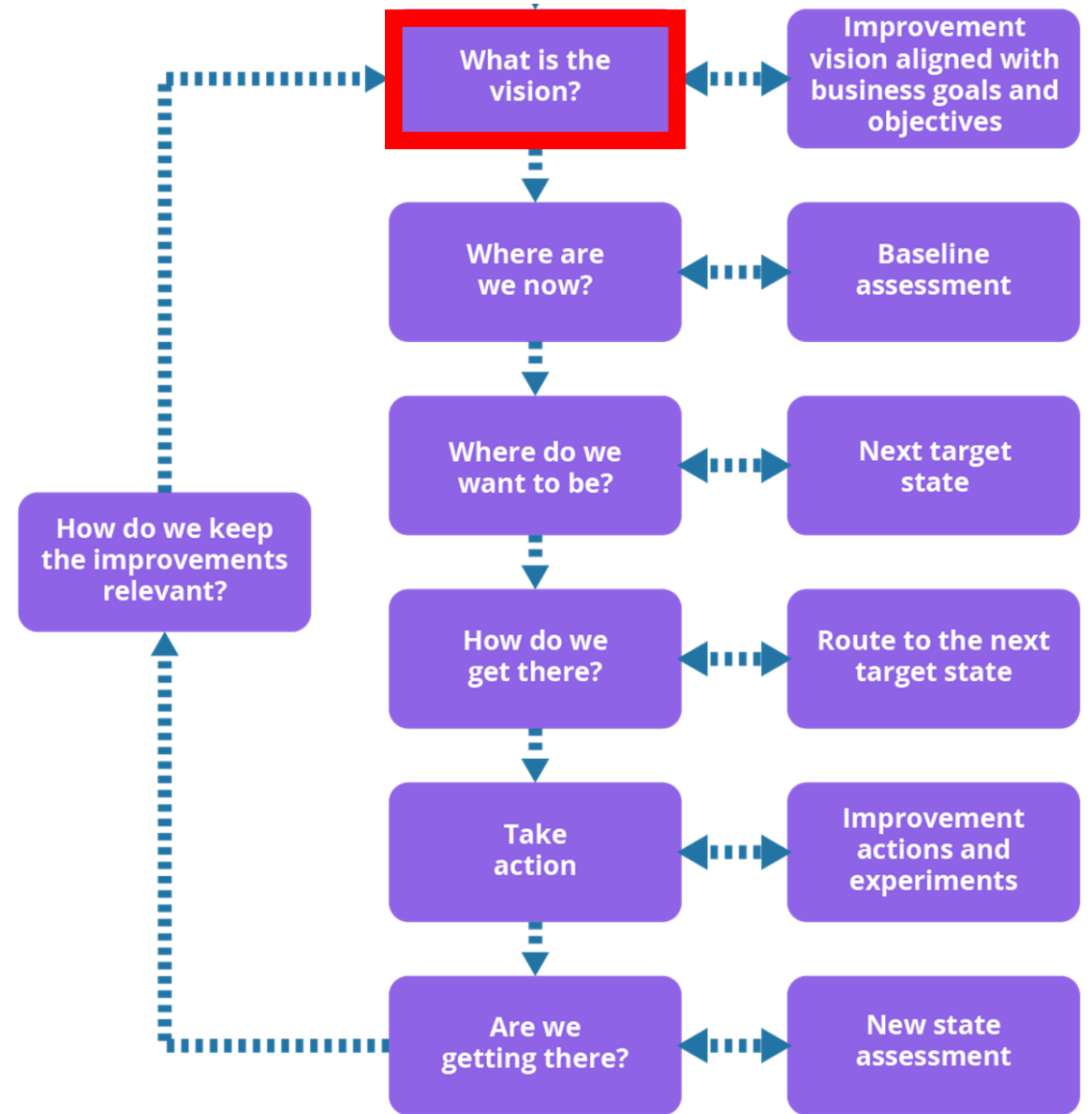


Figure 5.4 The ITIL Continual Improvement Model

What is the vision?

This **step focuses** on:

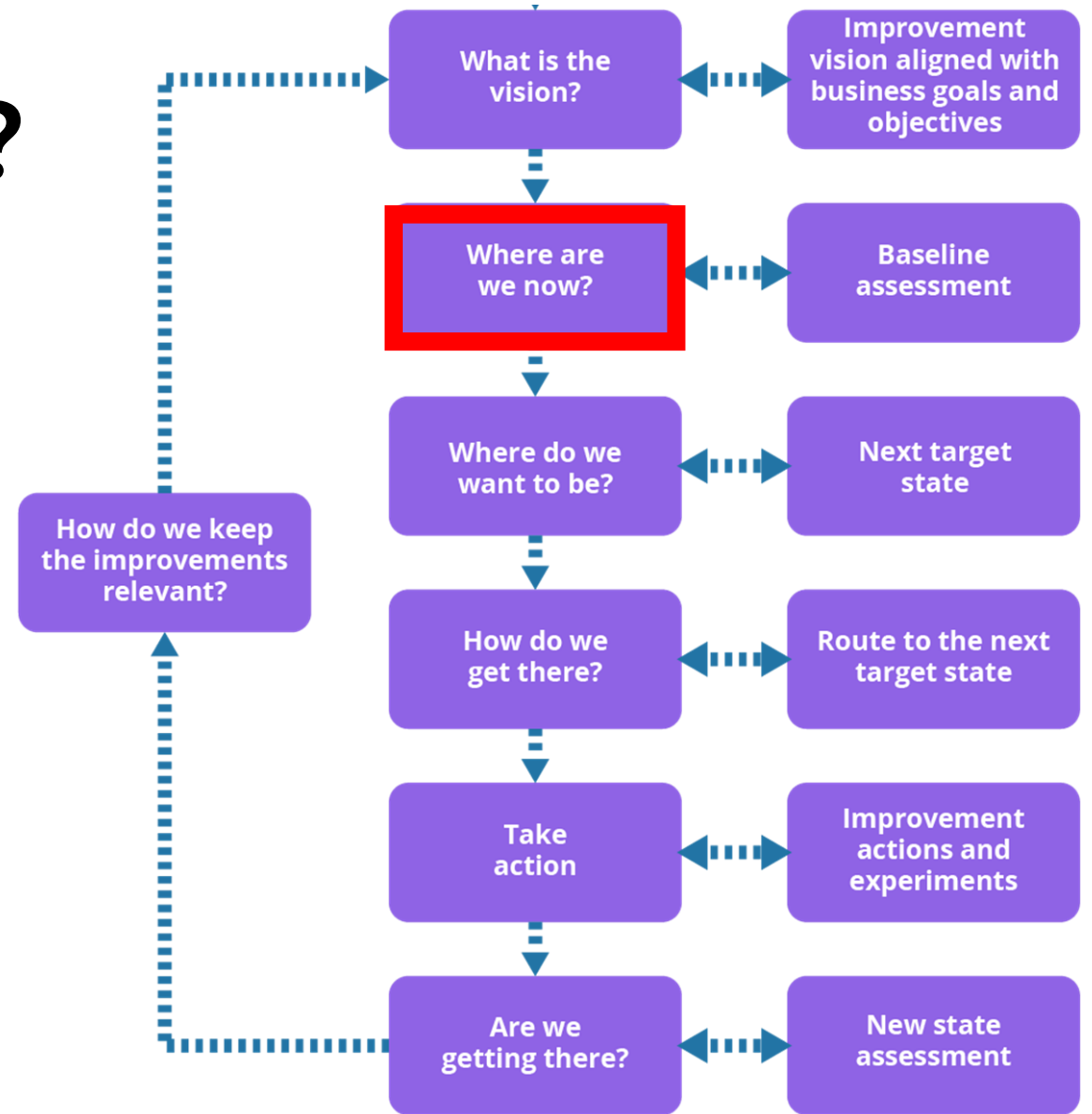
- **translating** the organization's vision and **objectives** for the **relevant** unit, **team**, or **individual**
- **creating** and agreeing a high-level vision for the **improvement**
- ensuring stakeholders understand the **expected value** and who has **authority** to proceed.



Where are we now?

Define the current state by **assessing**:

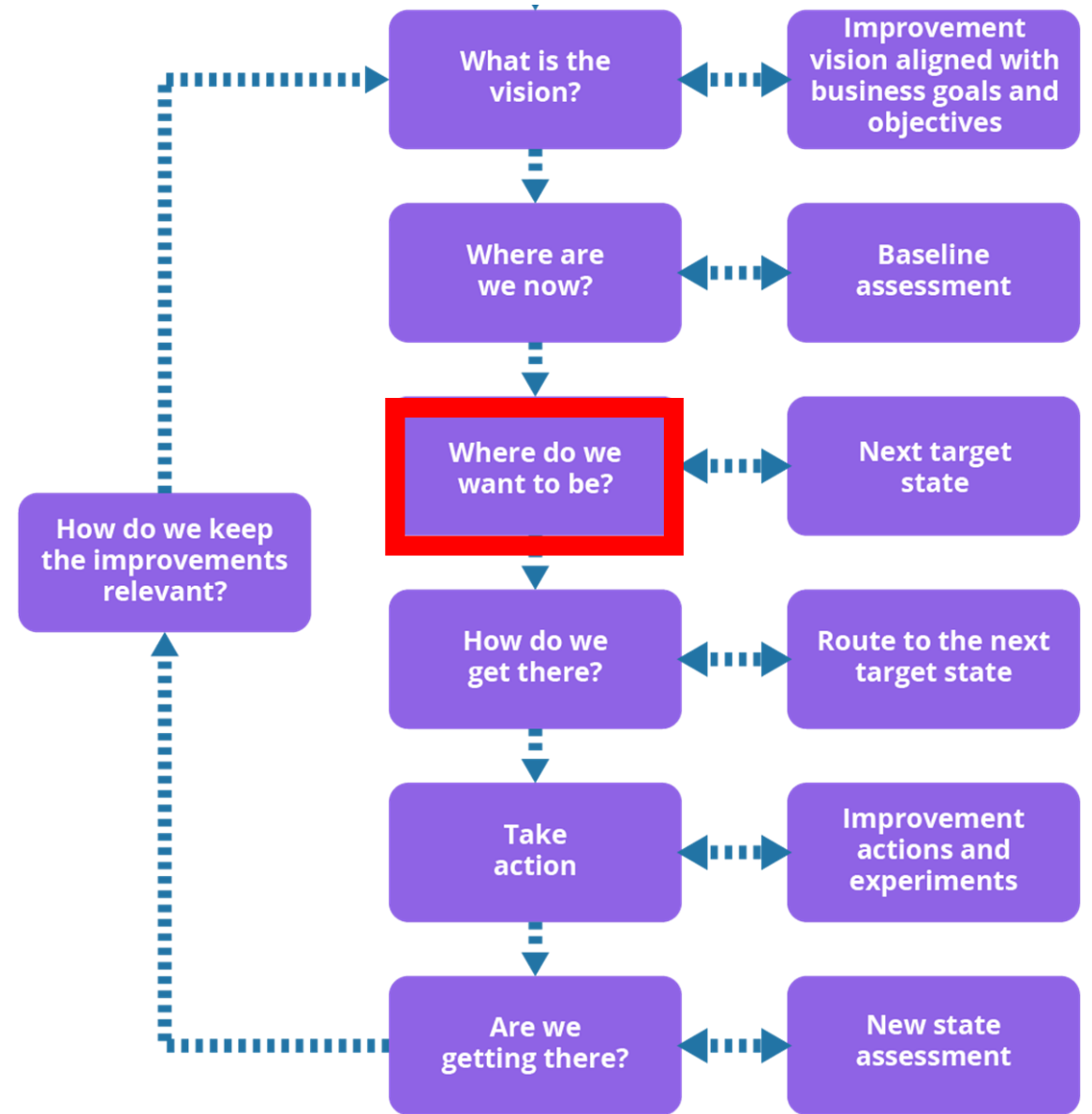
- **existing products and services**, including users' perception of value
- people's **competencies** and **skills**
- **workflows and processes** in place
- available technology **solutions**
- **feedback**, stories, and culture indicators.



Where do we want to be?

Define the desired future state (Point B) by:

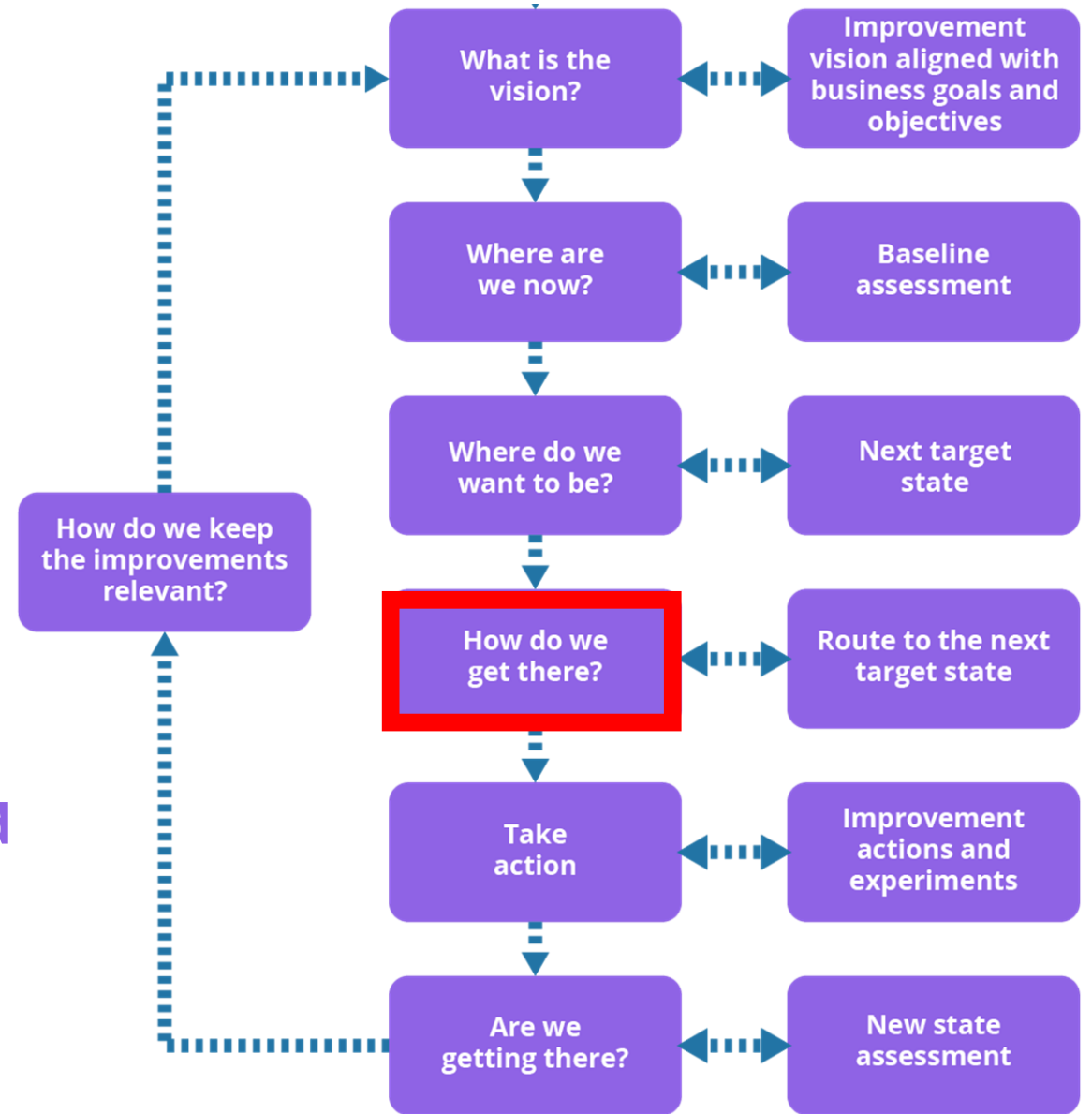
- setting **clear** improvement **objectives** with CSFs and KPIs, using SMART where possible
- describing the **target** in measurable terms or through **directional progress** criteria.



How do we get there?

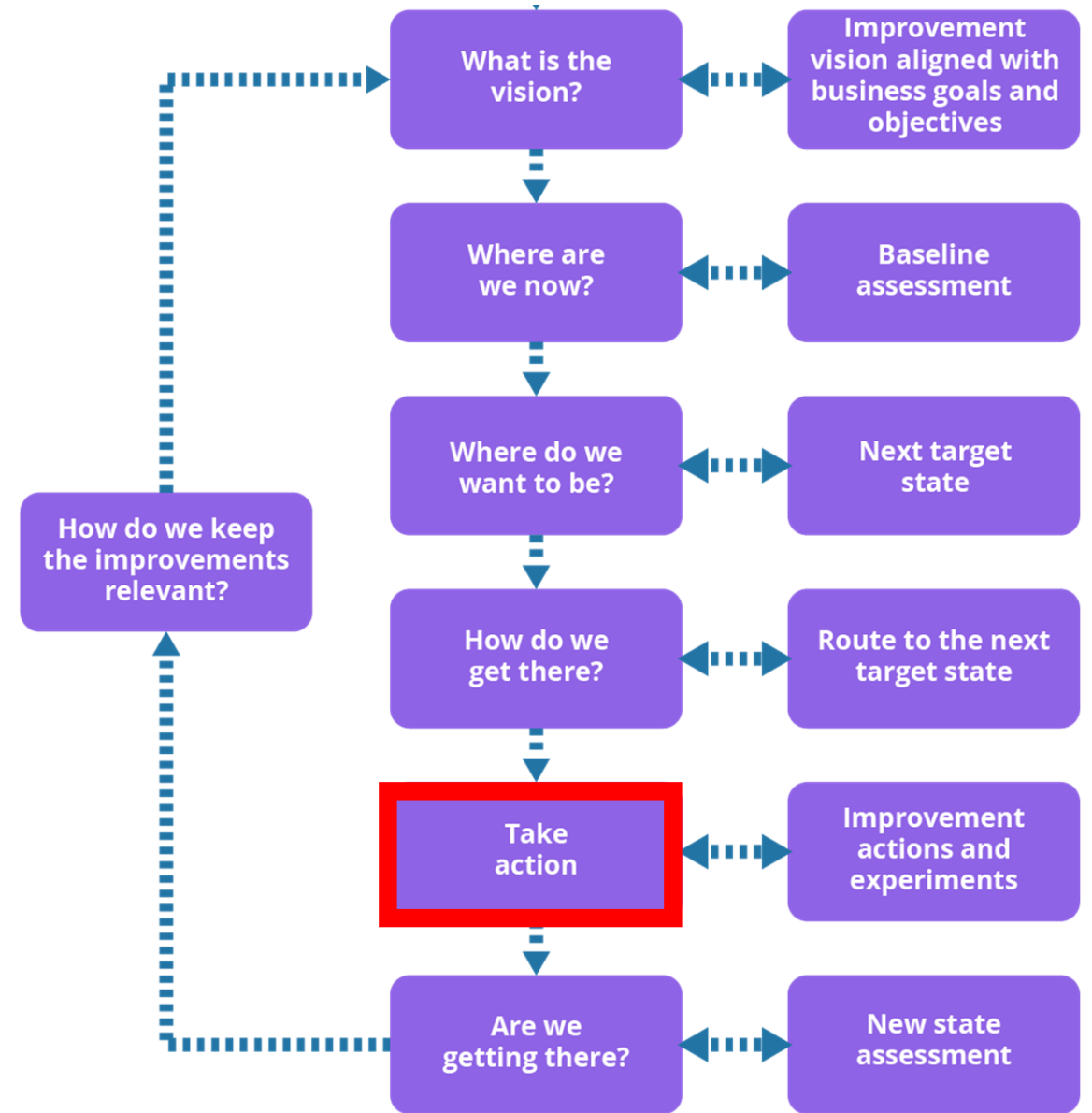
Plan the route from current to target state by:

- **combining** vision, current state, and target state with **expertise**
- working iteratively, re-evaluating, and **adjusting along the way**
- in unclear path, identify **hypotheses and experiments**.



Take action

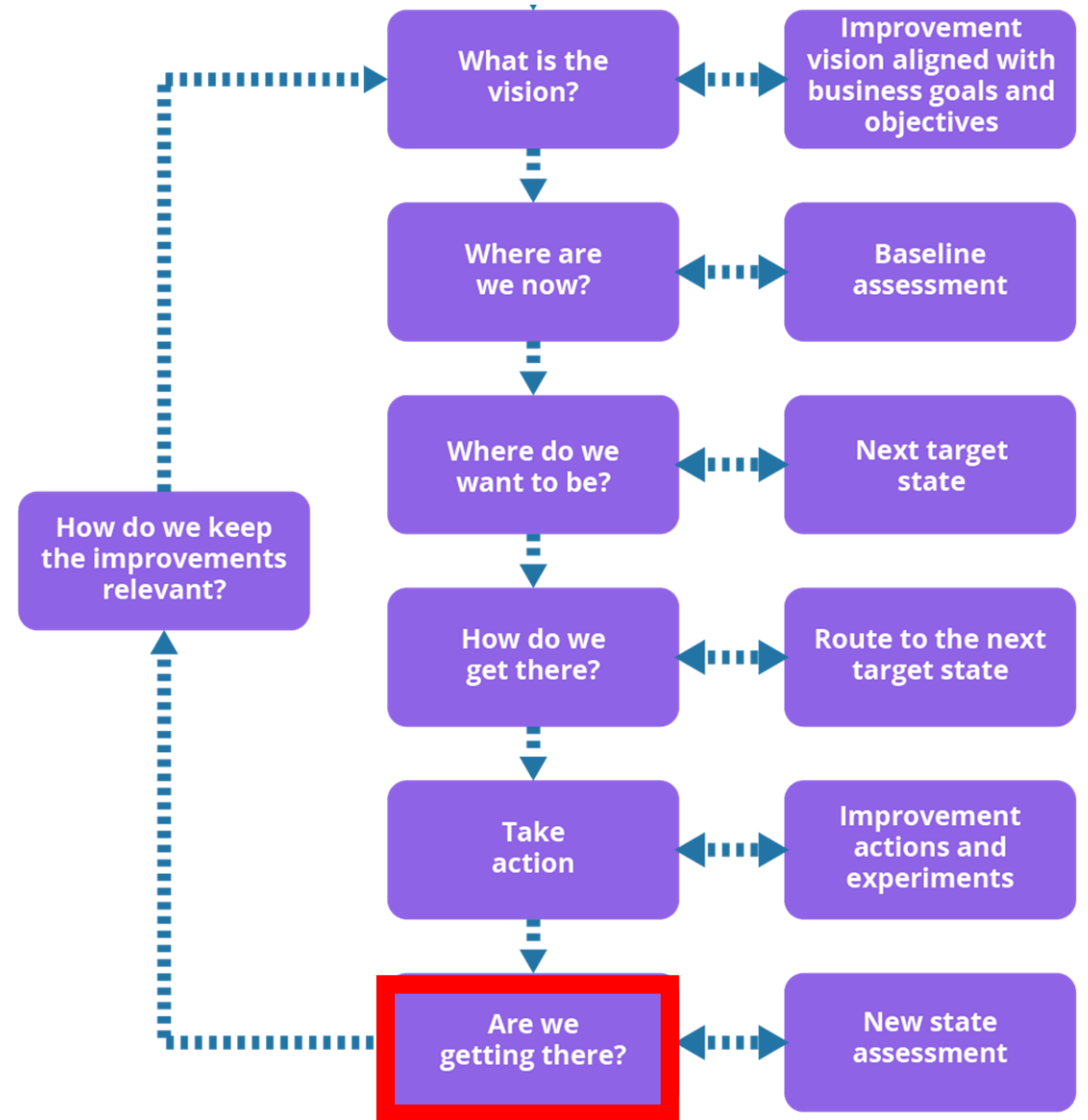
- Agreed actions and experiments are conducted
- As sequence, simultaneously or independently
- Work iteratively: adapt, change direction, or revisit earlier steps
- Stay focused on objectives while managing risks and visibility
- Focus on measuring progress



Are we getting there?

For each improvement initiative:

- assess progress **against objectives and value**
- if results fall short, plan additional actions or a new iteration
- if no SMART objectives exist, assess **direction of progress**: is the new state better and closer to the vision?
- confirm success and **reinforce progress** before moving to the next step.



How do we keep the improvements relevant?

When targets are met:

- Use change and knowledge management to embed improvements.
- Leaders/managers help teams adopt new ways of working.

When targets are not met:

- Inform stakeholders of reasons for failure.
- Analyse, document, and share lessons learned.
- Suggest improvements for next iteration.
- Treat deviations as learning opportunities, not blame.

